Speaking

Teacher's notes

Task 1

The students do an information gap activity.

Student A and B prompt: In this part of the test, you both have some information and some question prompts and you are going to ask each other some questions.

(*Hand out the texts and prompts for students to read. Allow 1 minute*)

Student A has some information about Yellowstone National Park and Student B has some information about The Alps Summer Activity Centre.

Use your prompts to think of questions to ask your partner about their information.

You have 1 minute to read the prompts and to think about the questions you are going to ask.

(*Allow 1 minute for students to read texts and think of questions. Answer questions as required.*)

Student A, you can ask your questions now.

(*Allow 1½ minutes for students to ask and answer questions. If both students are weak and struggle to start the information exchange, use questions to prompt them, e.g. How can you make a question about where Yellowstone National Park is?, etc.*)

Student B, you can ask your questions now.

(As for Student A)

Task 2

Students discuss the questions in pairs.

Student A and B prompt: In this part of the test, you are going to talk with a friend *(indicate through hand gestures that students are to talk to each other)* about environmental problems and what people can do to help nature and the environment.

You have one minute to think about what you want to say. Please ask me if you have any questions.

(*Allow 1 minute for students to read the scenario and prepare. Answer questions as required.*)

Student A, please start the conversation now.

(*Allow 3–4 minutes for students to do the task.*)

Thank you.

Task 3

The students each have three photos.

Prompt: In this part of the test you are both going to look at some photos and talk about them and then your partner will ask you two questions.

Student B, you are going to talk about these pictures showing different jobs. You are going to:

• describe the first picture

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• decide which job would be best for you and explain why
• explain why you rejected the other two jobs.

Student A, you are going to talk about these pictures showing different places to live. You are going to:
• describe the first picture
• decide which place would be best for you and your family to live and explain why
• explain why you rejected the other two places.

You have one minute to think about what you want to say. Please ask me if you have any questions.
(*Allow 1 minute for students to look at photos and prepare. Answer questions as required.*)

Student B, please talk about your photos now. (*Allow 1½ minutes for student to do the task.*)

Student A, please ask Student B your questions now.
Thank you.

Student A, please talk about your photos now. (*Allow 1½ minutes for student to do the task.*)

Student B, please ask Student A your questions now.
Thank you.

That is the end of the test.

Sample answers and mark schemes

Task 1
Can use *what, where, when, why* and *how* to ask for information.

Student A:

Student A: Where is the activity centre?
Student B: It's in the eastern part of France.
Student A: What can you do there?
Student B: You can do mountain biking, camping, kayaking and rock climbing.
Student A: When is it open?
Student B: It's open from April to October.
Student A: How can you travel to the activity centre?
Student B: By bus from the local town.
Student A: How much does a 1-week ticket cost?
Student B: It costs £200.
Student A: Can you do lessons to learn new sports?
Student B: Yes, you can because there are sports instructors.
Student A: Can you buy a tent?
Student B: Yes, there's a shop selling camping equipment.

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Student B:

Student B: Where is Yellowstone National Park?
Student A: It's in the northern part of the USA.
Student B: What can you see there?
Student A: You can see wolves, bears, rare birds and many other animals.
Student B: When is the best time to visit?
Student A: You can see most animals in the summer.
Student B: How can you travel in the park?
Student A: You can travel around the park on special buses.
Student B: How much does it cost to go to the park with a car?
Student A: It costs $30.
Student B: Can you buy books in the park?
Student A: Yes, there is a bookshop there.
Student B: Is there a museum?
Student A: Yes, there is.

Task 2

Can say what they like and dislike.
Can express opinions and attitudes in a simple way.
Can express basic superlatives with common regular and irregular adjectives.
Can generally express belief, opinion, agreement and disagreement with some detail.
Can express basic personal intentions using *going to*.

Students A and B:

Student A: What do you think the biggest environmental problems are today?
Student B: Well, I think global warming is the biggest problem because it is everywhere and changes the whole world.
Student A: Yes, and I think pollution is a big problem too, especially in the rivers and oceans.
Student B: Yes, and in the air too. This is why we have global warming.
Student A: What do you think governments must do?
Student B: I think they must stop pollution from factories and power stations. They must spend more on making clean electricity. What do you think?
Student A: Yes, and they must stop illegal fishing because it is killing too many fish. What should people do to help?
Student B: They should use less electricity and switch off their lights and computers if they don't use them.
Student A: Yes, and they can walk or cycle and not use their cars so much.
Student B: And make sure the things they buy in the supermarket don't damage the environment.
Student A: What are you going to do to help more?
Student B: I'm going to always switch off my tablet if I don't use it and I'm going to share more things on Facebook about how to help. What about you?
Student A: I'm going to raise some money for charities that help the environment, maybe do a long swim or a bungee jump.
Student B: I don't like high places – I couldn't do that!

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Task 3

Can describe a picture and what is happening in it using the Present Continuous.
Can say what they like and dislike.
Can explain what they like or dislike about something.
Can express basic superlatives with common regular and irregular adjectives.
Can express opinions and attitudes in a simple way.
Can generally express belief, opinion, agreement and disagreement with some detail.

Student B:

The photos show three different jobs. The first photo is a photo of a doctor. She is with an ill girl and her mother in the hospital and they are talking about what is wrong with the girl. The other photos show a picture of a teacher and a gardener. I think the best job for me will be the teacher. I think this because I like people and helping people so this is a good job for helping. I really like Maths and I think I will be good at explaining how to do maths to other people. I think it will be a difficult job but good because it's nice to see people get better at things. The other jobs will not be so good because I don't like blood and things like that so I will not be a good doctor. Doctors need to know a lot about the body and how it works but I don't enjoy this. The other job, working in a garden, will not be good because you have to work outside and that's not good in the winter or when it's raining, so the teacher will be best for me.

Possible questions from Student A:

What kind of school do you want to work in?
Do you want to teach other subjects or just Maths?

Student A:

The photos show three different places to live. The first photo shows a big city and there are some flats and probably offices and a lot of traffic on the road. I think the best place for me and my family to live is by the sea. There is always something to do there like walk on the beach or go swimming in the sea in the summer. We have a dog and he will really enjoy the beach. It will be good in the summer because there will be lots of tourists coming there and it's always fun if there are lots of people. But not like a city which is crowded, loud and dangerous and if you want to be alone, you can't walk on the beach or in the countryside. Maybe the city is fun in some ways because there is always lots to do and there are so many shops and places to visit. But I prefer to visit the city and live by the sea. The house in the village in the other photo looks nice but I think life in a village is a bit boring. There's nothing to do there at all so it's not good for me and my family.

Possible questions from Student B:

Which cities do you like to visit?
What will you do in the place by the sea in the winter?

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Speaking

The tasks together are worth 20 marks. Award up to 4 marks for each section of the mark scheme, according to the descriptions below.

Marks	Task achievement	Spoken production and fluency	Spoken interaction	Range	Accuracy
0-1	Phonological, lexical and grammatical inaccuracies impede almost all task achievement. May not even achieve the simplest part of the task. Many responses will not be attempted (lack of linguistic resources or misunderstanding of input).	Hesitation will be extremely intrusive. Available time will not be utilised effectively. Pronunciation of some single words may be intelligible. Any longer utterances will be difficult to understand. No natural use of stress, rhythm and intonation to express meaning.	Control will probably be insufficient for even the simplest of tasks. There may be no utterances even at sentence level. Will be hesitant and unsure when responding to teacher and/or peer input.	The range of language, lexical and grammatical, is probably insufficient even for simple prompts.	Some words or short phrases may be accurate but frequent grammatical and lexical errors, even in basic language, impede almost all coherence and communication of ideas.
1-2	Phonological, lexical and grammatical inaccuracies impede task achievement. Achieves only simplest part of the task in a limited way. Many responses may not be appropriate or are not attempted (lack of linguistic resources or misunderstanding of input).	Hesitation may be excessive and frequent. Available time will probably not be utilised effectively. Pronunciation of single words may be intelligible but longer utterances difficult to understand. Little or no natural use of stress, rhythm and intonation to express meaning.	Control may be sufficient for very simple tasks but not more complex ones. No extended discourse. May be hesitant and unsure when responding to teacher and/or peer input.	The range of language, lexical and grammatical, is sufficient for simple prompts but not for more complex tasks.	Some words or short phrases may be accurate but frequent grammatical and lexical errors, even in basic language, impede coherence and communication of ideas.
2-3	Achieves most of the task, but in a limited way. Some responses may be inappropriate, ambiguous or not attempted (lack of linguistic resources or misunderstanding of input).	Hesitation may be evident but is not excessive. Available time may not always be utilised effectively. Pronunciation of most utterances will be intelligible with occasional words difficult to understand. Attempts made to use stress, rhythm and intonation to express meaning.	Control is sufficient for simple tasks and some more complex ones. Some extended discourse. May be occasional, but not intrusive, hesitation and uncertainty when responding to teacher and/or peer input.	The range of language, lexical and grammatical, is sufficient for simple prompts and for most more complex tasks. There may be little or no lexis or structure used that is above the target level.	Most words, short phrases and some longer utterances will be accurate but occasional grammatical and lexical errors, may impede coherence and communication of ideas.

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3-4	Achieves all of the task in a appropriate and comprehensive way. All responses are appropriate and unambiguous	Only natural hesitation evident, but this is not excessive. Available time is consistently utilised effectively. Pronunciation of all utterances will be intelligible with only occasional mispronunciation of individual words. Stress, rhythm and intonation used well to express meaning.	Control is sufficient for all tasks. Multiple occasions of extended discourse. No intrusive hesitation or uncertainty when responding to teacher and/or peer input.	The range of language, lexical and grammatical, is sufficient for all tasks. There may be multiple examples of lexis and/or structure used that is above the target level.	All words, short phrases and longer utterances will be accurate with only occasional grammatical and lexical errors, which do not impede coherence and communication of ideas.

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